Kavin's mealtime safety sheet

Solids from Nov 2026 · Born 18 May 2026
Keep on the fridge next to the high chair

CALL 000

- Choking not cleared by back blows and chest thrusts
- Difficult or noisy breathing, wheeze, persistent cough
- Swollen tongue or throat, change in cry or voice
- Pale and floppy, or unresponsive
- Lips or face turning blue
- In New Zealand: dial 111

Gagging or choking?

GAGGING: normal, he's learning

- **Noisy:** coughing, spluttering, retching
- Red face, watery eyes, tongue pushed forward
- Breathing and making sounds

Do: stay calm, keep him upright, let him work it out. Don't put your fingers in his mouth or pat his back.

CHOKING: emergency

- **Silent**, or weak high-pitched sounds
- Can't cry or cough properly
- Lips or face turning blue or pale
- Panicked look, eyes wide

Do: start first aid below straight away and get someone to call 000.

1. **Call 000** or have someone call. Put the phone on speaker.
2. Lay him **face-down along your forearm**, head lower than his body, supporting his jaw.
3. Up to **5 back blows** between the shoulder blades with the heel of your hand. Check after each.
4. Not cleared? Turn him face-up on a firm surface. Up to **5 chest thrusts**: two fingers, centre of chest, just below the nipple line.
5. **Keep alternating** until it clears or help arrives. If he goes unresponsive, start CPR.

Allergic reaction

MILD TO MODERATE

- Hives or welts
- Swelling of lips, face or eyes
- Vomiting

Do: stop the food. Note the time, take photos. Watch closely for severe signs. Call the GP or healthdirect. Don't give that food again until the GP says so.

SEVERE (ANAPHYLAXIS)

- Difficult or noisy breathing, wheeze, persistent cough
- Swollen tongue or throat, change in cry
- Pale and floppy

Do: call 000 now. Lay him flat. If breathing is hard you can hold him upright, but if he's pale or floppy keep him lying flat.

USUALLY NOT ALLERGY Redness around the mouth only (tomato, berries). If nothing else, try the food again.

New allergen days

- Morning meal, when he's well, someone home all day
- One new allergen per day
- Start with **¼ tsp**. No reaction after 30 min? Give **½ tsp** more
- Next time 1 tsp, then 2 tsp
- **Watch for 2 hours** afterwards
- Once in, keep each allergen going **at least weekly**

See the GP (not urgent)

- After any mild reaction
- Ongoing vomiting or diarrhoea, blood in poo, fewer wet nappies
- Constipation lasting several days or painful
- Not managing lumps by 9 to 10 months

Never before 12 months

- Honey (any form)
- Whole or chopped nuts (until 5 years). Smooth nut butters are fine
- Raw carrot, celery, raw apple slices
- Whole grapes, blueberries, cherry tomatoes (squash or quarter)
- Popcorn, hard crackers, lollies, sausage rounds
- Raw or runny egg, unpasteurised dairy
- Cow's or rice milk as a drink (fine in cooking)
- Added salt, stock cubes, soy sauce, fish sauce, sugar, chilli
- Juice, tea, soft drinks
- Shark (flake), swordfish, marlin

Every meal: sitting upright in the high chair, an adult watching, never in a car seat or pram.

Emergency	healthdirect (24/7)	Pregnancy, Birth & Baby nurse	GP
000	**1800 022 222**	**1800 882 436**	_____

Based on ASCIA 2026 infant feeding guideline, NHMRC Infant Feeding Guidelines, RACGP and ANZCOR infant choking first aid.

General guidance. Ask your GP about anything specific to Kavin.